

# Jiadong Li

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## Summary

Master's student in Computer Science at Northwestern University with experience in backend systems, AWS cloud services, and applied machine learning. Proven ability to improve system efficiency, including reducing processing time by 50% through custom tool development. Experienced in building scalable applications and collaborating in international teams.

## Education

**Northwestern University, USA | Master's in Computer Science**

Evanston, IL

**GPA: 3.9**

Sep 2025 - Dec 2026

Relevant coursework: Machine Learning, AI Programming, Introduction to Networking, Scalable Software

Architecture, Practicum Intelligent Info System, Introduction to AI

**University of California Irvine, USA | B.S. in Computer Science**

Irvine, CA

**GPA: 3.68**

Sep 2021 - Mar 2025

Multiple Dean's Honor List

Relevant coursework: Machine/Data Mining, Intro Artificial Intelligence, Program in C/C++

## Experience

**Carl Zeiss | R&D Intern | Apr 2025 – Aug 2025**

- Developed X-ray-based defect detection algorithms for cylindrical batteries using computer vision techniques.
- Developed a Python/PyQt tagging tool replacing legacy Java system, reducing labeling time by 50% and enabling modular plugin integration.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams in Germany and China to deploy models via Zeiss cloud training platform.
- Works closely with team members to provide an industry-leading 3-D X-ray automatic flaw detection solution for car battery production. Which got adopted by BMW in Germany.

**Johnson & Johnson | R&D Intern | Jun 2023 – Sep 2023**

- Ensured data integrity and compliance in a medical environment handling sensitive user data.
- Actively participated in the development of a skull surgery appliance using an industry-leading 3D printer.
- Developed an automatic logging software for the file system using Python that can reduce the time needed to track users of different software.
- Used C++ to create a file retrieval system for the company's file system. This reduces a 40-minute job to a background, automatic process.

## Activities & Projects

**SAYS | Member & Leader | Jan 2026 – Present**

- Defined core system architecture and feature roadmap for a voice-first AI application
- Led cross-team coordination between university researchers and external clients to drive product development
- Evaluated trade-offs between voice and screen-based interaction to improve usability in noisy or public environments
- Designed and prototyped a voice-first interaction system integrating speech recognition, LLM-based dialogue, and text-to-speech pipelines

**EnergAlz | Member | Jan 2025 – Mar 2025**

- Developed an RL agent using PPO and SAC algorithms to minimize energy consumption in a simulated environment using a decentralized approach.
- Implemented and tuned reward functions to improve energy efficiency and battery usage.
- Analyzed the performance difference between PPO and SAC, which offers insight into the difference between the two approaches and helps future CityLearn challenge participants.

**Vex Robotics Contest | Team Leader | Sep 2020 – Jan 2021**

- Led a team of 5 members to design, build, and program a competitive robotics system, resulting in a gold medal finish
- Coordinated team roles, timelines, and strategy to ensure efficient development and competition readiness
- Designed and assembled robot hardware and contributed to control logic, improving performance and reliability during matches

**Papergon | Co-Founder & Member | May 2019 – May 2021**

- Co-founded a student team promoting paperless education, deploying system at Dulwich College
- Secured \$15,000 funding and managed project execution across a 9-member team

## Additional

**Language Skills:** Chinese(Native),Fluent in English, Japanese, Beginner German

**Technical Skills:** C++, Python, Lisp, JavaScript, SQL, Pytest, Pytorch, Github, AWS, Git